

**NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT
OF EDUCATION**

RULE 20

**REGULATIONS FOR THE APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION
PROGRAMS**

**TITLE 92, NEBRASKA ADMINISTRATIVE CODE,
CHAPTER 20**

**EFFECTIVE DATE
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**State of Nebraska
Department of Education
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TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

NUMERICAL TABLE OF CONTENTS

<u>SUBJECT</u>	<u>STATUTORY AUTHORITY</u>	<u>CODE SECTION</u>
General Information	79-318	001
Definition of Terms	79-318, 79-807	002
Requirements for Educator Preparation Program Approval	79-318	003
Educator Preparation Program Requirements	79-318, 79-814.01	004
Teacher Preparation Academic Program Requirements	79-318	005
Administrator Preparation Academic Program Requirements	79-318	006
Program Quality Indicators	79-318	007
Provisions for Notice and Hearing	79-318	008
Pilot Programs and Processes	79-318	009

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

ALPHABETICAL TABLE OF CONTENTS

<u>SUBJECT</u>	<u>STATUTORY AUTHORITY</u>	<u>CODE SECTION</u>
Administrator Preparation Academic Program Requirements	79-318	006
Definition of Terms	79-318, 79-807	002
Educator Preparation Program Requirements	79-318, 79-814.01	004
Pilot Programs and Processes	79-318	009
General Information	79-318	001
Program Quality Indicators	79-318	007
Provisions for Notice and Hearing	79-318	008
Requirements for Educator Preparation Program Approval	79-318	003
Teacher Preparation Academic Program Requirements	79-318	005

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

001 General Information.

001.01 Statutory Authority. This chapter is adopted pursuant to Neb. Rev. Stat. § 79-318.

001.02 Scope and Application. This chapter provides procedures for the approval of educator preparation programs conducted in Nebraska standard institutions of higher education and designed for the purpose of certificating teachers and administrators and other professional school personnel requiring certification.

001.03 Related Regulations. Throughout this chapter reference is made to other Department of Education regulations relating to teachers and administrators. Procedures for the issuance of certificates to teach, counsel, or supervise in Nebraska schools are contained in Title 92, Nebraska Administrative Code (NAC), Chapter 21. 92 NAC 24 contains regulations regarding the issuance of endorsements on teaching, administrative, or special services certificates in Nebraska. 92 NAC 27 contains regulations and standards for professional practices criteria. Electronic access to these regulations is available from the Department at <https://www.education.ne.gov/legal/current-nde-rules-regulations/>.

001.04 Implementation Date. The implementation date of this chapter will be the effective date of approval.

002 Definition of Terms. As used in this chapter:

002.01 Academic year means a school year which consists of two (2) regular consecutive semesters that occur from fall through spring.

002.02 Accreditation means the status of public recognition that an accrediting agency grants to an educational institution and is recognized by the United States Department of Education.

002.03 Advanced program means a program at the postbaccalaureate level for (a) educators who have previously completed initial preparation or (b) the preparation of other school professionals.

002.04 Board means the State Board of Education.

002.05 Candidate means an individual admitted to, or enrolled in, a program for the initial or advanced preparation or the continuing professional development of educators.

002.06 Certificate means a teaching, administrative, or special services certificate issued by the Department pursuant to 92 NAC 21.

002.07 Clinical practice means a culminating, supervised experience that provides a candidate with opportunities to demonstrate competence in the professional role for which the candidate is preparing and that includes student teaching or an internship.

002.08 Commissioner means the State Commissioner of Education.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

002.09 Cooperating educator means an educator employed in a setting utilized for a clinical practice who has the appropriate certification and experience to perform observation, coaching, mentoring, and/or evaluation of a candidate.

002.10 Coursework means the experiences required to complete the preparation program and may include class instruction, field experiences, or other required activities.

002.11 Credit hour means the equivalent of fifteen (15) instructional class periods of fifty (50) minutes or more.

002.12 Department means the State Department of Education, which is comprised of the Board and the Commissioner.

002.13 Diversity means differences among groups of people and individuals based on ethnicity, race, socioeconomic status, gender, exceptionalities, language, religion, sexual orientation, and/or geographical areas.

002.14 Educator means a holder of a teaching, administrative or special services certificate.

002.15 Educator certificate means a certificate issued pursuant to standards comparable and equivalent to those in 92 NAC 21.

002.16 Educator preparation program means the system of procedures, coursework, and activities in a college, school, or department of an approved standard institution of higher education that result in the initial or advanced preparation of teachers, administrators, and other school professionals.

002.17 Endorsement means an area of specialization indicated on a certificate issued pursuant to 92 NAC 21 signifying that the individual has met specific content preparation requirements contained in 92 NAC 24.

002.18 Exceptional expertise requirement means documented scholarship, skill, or experience in the priorities set by the educator preparation program, such as content specialization, diversity, assessment, or technology.

002.19 Faculty means all professional education faculty, including adjunct faculty and graduate students, employed by a standard institution of higher education who teach one or more courses in professional education and/or supervise field experiences.

002.20 Field experience means an opportunity for candidates to observe, assist, tutor, instruct, and/or conduct research to develop professional education knowledge, skills, and dispositions. Field experiences include practicum and clinical practice requirements. Field experiences are designed and implemented through collaboration with school partners and faculty and occur in school systems or other settings serving students.

002.21 Human relations requirement has the same meaning as human relations training in Neb. Rev. Stat. § 79-807 and as required by Neb. Rev. Stat. § 79-808.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

002.22 Initial program means a program at the baccalaureate or postbaccalaureate level that prepares candidates for their first certificate. They include five-year programs, master's programs, and other postbaccalaureate and alternate route programs that prepare individuals for their first certificate.

002.23 Internship means a clinical practice in which candidates practice and demonstrate the knowledge, skills, and professional dispositions required for advanced programs.

002.24 Practicum means a field experience completed prior to a candidate's clinical practice.

002.25 Professional dispositions means candidate attitudes, values, and beliefs demonstrated in interactions with students, families, educators, and communities consistent with ethical performance criteria contained in 92 NAC 27.

002.26 Professional education coursework means coursework, including field experience, designed to develop educator competencies, including, but not limited to, student development, learning differences, learning environments, content knowledge and its application, assessment, planning for instruction, instructional strategies, collaboration, and ethical practice.

002.27 School partner means school systems and other education programs that collaborate with the educator preparation program in designing, developing, and implementing field experiences, delivery of instruction, and research.

002.28 School system means an institution that is accredited or approved by the Department to provide instruction at any level PK-Grade 12, including an educational service unit accredited by the Department.

002.29 Special authorization means a process by which the Department may grant approval for a standard institution of higher education to offer a pilot endorsement program.

002.30 Special education requirement has the same meaning as special education training in Neb. Rev. Stat. § 79-807 and as required by Neb. Rev. Stat. § 79-809.

002.31 Standard institution of higher education, or institution has the same meaning as in Neb. Rev. Stat. § 79-807.

002.32 Student teaching means a clinical practice in a school system which provides an initial preparation candidate with an experience to demonstrate competence in the professional role for which the candidate is preparing.

002.33 Terminal degree means the highest degree available in a specific field of preparation or recognized by the profession.

003 Requirements for Educator Preparation Program Approval

003.01 Original Educator Preparation Program Approval

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

003.01A Letter of Application and Institutional Planning Report. Any Nebraska institution of higher education may apply for approval of its educator preparation program by submitting a letter of intent to seek approval and an Institutional Planning Report (IPR) signed by the chief academic officer of the institution on behalf of the governing board of the institution. These documents must be received by the Commissioner on or before January 15 of the calendar year in which the institution seeks to begin the approval process.

003.01B Governing Board Approval. The IPR must include documentation that the governing board of the institution has approved the plans and a time table whereby the institution will meet each of the requirements to become a standard institution of higher education within four (4) years.

003.01C Chapter 20 Compliance. The IPR must include the procedures and time table for compliance with the requirements in Sections 004 through 007 of this chapter.

003.01D Collaboration and Support of School Systems. The IPR must contain statements of support from school systems documenting their collaboration and assistance in planning to provide field experiences which meet the requirements of this chapter and 92 NAC 24.

003.01E The IPR must contain documentation that the institution is accredited.

003.02 Initial Provisional Approval

003.02A The Commissioner, after receiving the institution's request to begin the process of becoming a standard institution of higher education, must appoint a team to visit the institution and report on the institution's ability to comply with the provisions of this chapter.

003.02A1 The team must schedule a visit to the institution within sixty (60) days after receiving the IPR.

003.02A2 The team must file a recommendation with the Commissioner within sixty (60) days after the scheduled visit to the institution.

003.02A3 Following a review of the institutional visit report, the Commissioner must file a recommendation with the Board regarding the application and notify the institution of the recommendations. Notification must be sent by certified mail to the chief academic officer of the institution. The institution will have thirty (30) days after receipt of the recommendation to request an opportunity for a hearing before the Board as provided in Section 008 of this chapter.

003.02A4 Following a review of the Commissioner's recommendation, and after giving the institution an opportunity for a hearing, if requested, the Board must either approve or deny the institution's implementation of the plan under provisional approval. Provisional approval permits the institution to phase in an educator preparation program, excluding clinical practice, over a period of time not to exceed three (3) years.

003.03 Continuing Provisional Approval

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

003.03A Provisional Approval Report. By March 1 of each year during provisional approval, the institution must file the Provisional Approval Report with the Commissioner which includes:

003.03A1 Documentation of written notification made to all candidates taking education courses that the institution has provisional approval, but is not yet approved for recommending certification;

003.03A2 Statements of continuing participation by the school systems in which the institution is placing candidates for field experiences; and

003.03A3 Documentation of the degree to which the institution is in compliance with all applicable sections of this chapter , excluding clinical practice; 92 NAC 23; and 92 NAC 24. The Provisional Approval Report must also indicate how, in each succeeding year, the institution is progressing toward total compliance, excluding clinical practice.

003.03B The Commissioner may respond each year with a scheduled visit by a team or staff, to the institution within sixty (60) days after receiving the Provisional Approval Report.

003.03C The team or staff conducting such a visit must file a recommendation with the Commissioner within thirty (30) days after a scheduled visit.

003.03D Following a review of the report, the Commissioner must file a recommendation with the Board regarding the application and notify the institution of the recommendations. Notification must be sent by certified mail to the chief academic officer of the institution. The institution will have thirty (30) days after receipt of the recommendation to request an opportunity for a hearing before the Board as provided in Section 008 of this chapter.

003.03E Following a review of the Commissioner's recommendation, and after giving the institution an opportunity for a hearing, if requested, the Board must either approve or deny continuation of provisional or recommend temporary approval.

003.04 Temporary Approval to Offer an Educator Preparation Program. If the Commissioner recommends and the Board concurs, the institution may be granted a one (1) year temporary approval. Temporary approval allows the institution to place candidates and to recommend graduates of the program to the Department for certification. Temporary approval may be renewed on a yearly basis for a maximum of three (3) years, using the process found in Sections 003.04A through 003.04F of this chapter for each of these years.

003.04A By March 1 of each year in which the institution is operating with temporary approval, the institution must file a Temporary Approval Report with the Commissioner. The Temporary Approval Report must document complete compliance with all applicable sections of this chapter and 92 NAC 24.

003.04B The Commissioner may respond with a scheduled visit by a team or staff, to the institution within sixty (60) days after receiving the Temporary Approval Report.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

003.04C The team or staff conducting such a visit must file a recommendation with the Commissioner within thirty (30) days after the scheduled visit.

003.04D Following a review of the report, the Commissioner must file a recommendation with the Board regarding the application and notify the institution of the recommendations. Notification must be sent by certified mail to the chief academic officer of the institution. The institution will have thirty (30) days after receipt of the recommendation to request an opportunity for a hearing before the Board as provided in Section 008 of this chapter.

003.04E Following a review of the Commissioner's recommendation, and after giving the institution an opportunity for a hearing, if requested, the Board must exercise one of the following options: (a) approve the institution as a standard institution of higher education, (b) grant it temporary approval for another year, or (c) deny the institution further status as an educator preparation program.

003.04F Once the Board has approved the institution as a standard institution of higher education, the institution is subject to the provisions in Section 003.05 of this chapter.

003.05 Continuing Approval of an Educator Preparation Program. Continuing approval will be for the period of August 1 through July 31 of the next year and will be conditional upon the institution's compliance with the requirements in Sections 003 through 007 of this chapter. An institution's failure to meet a numbered regulation will be considered a violation and will be subject to the provisions of Section 003.05C of this chapter.

003.05A Annual Board Approval. The institution must submit a list of endorsements offered, program outcomes, assurance of compliance, and correction of areas of non-compliance, if applicable, by May 15 of each year. Recommended forms may be found on the NDE Educator Preparation website.

003.05B State Program Review. At least once every seven (7) years, the Commissioner must conduct a full review of the educator preparation program, including both an offsite and an onsite component, to determine compliance with all applicable provisions of this chapter and 92 NAC 24.

003.05B1 The state program review must be conducted by a state team, appointed by the Commissioner, which includes representation from the Nebraska Council on Teacher Education (NCTE), persons with content knowledge in the endorsement areas offered by the educator preparation program, and Department staff.

003.05B2 For institutions participating in a national accreditation review of educator preparation programs, the state program review must be conducted to coordinate with the national accreditation process.

003.05B3 Offsite Review

003.05B3a Institutional Report. Qualitative and quantitative information regarding compliance with the requirements of Sections 004 through 007 of this chapter must be submitted on a schedule established by the Commissioner. Recommended forms may be found on the NDE Educator Preparation website.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

003.05B3b Endorsement Program Folios. Information regarding each endorsement program offered by the institution must be submitted on a schedule established by the Commissioner. Recommended forms may be found on the NDE Educator Preparation website. Folio information must include:

003.05B3b1 Documentation of compliance with the endorsement requirements in 92 NAC 24;

003.05B3b2 Quantitative and qualitative candidate assessment and performance information; and

003.05B3b3 Changes made in response to data regarding candidate or graduate performance and/or in response to the needs of school systems.

003.05B4 Onsite Review. An onsite review must be conducted to validate information submitted by the institution in response to Section 003.05B3 of this chapter or to acquire additional information to determine compliance with the provisions of this chapter and 92 NAC 24.

003.05B5 Results of the state program review must be reported to the Board during the annual approval meeting.

003.05C Correction of Areas of Noncompliance. The institution will have until May 1 of the year following the Board's annual approval decision to correct areas of noncompliance identified in Section 003.05 of this chapter.

003.05C1 Approval on Probation. The Commissioner may recommend to the Board approval on probation for an institution with uncorrected areas of noncompliance as of May 1 of the first year following the Board's annual approval decision.

003.05C2 Denial of Approval. The Commissioner may recommend to the Board denial of approval for an institution with uncorrected areas of noncompliance as of May 1 of the year following designation of approval on probation.

003.05C3 Notification and Appeal. The Commissioner must notify the chief academic officer of the institution of a recommendation for probation or denial of approval in writing by certified mail. The institution will have thirty (30) days after receipt of the recommendation to request an opportunity for a hearing as provided in Section 008 of this chapter.

003.06 Special Endorsement Authorization. A Nebraska standard institution of higher education may apply for approval of a special authorization to offer an endorsement program not included in 92 NAC 24.

003.06A Application for Approval. An application must be received by the Commissioner on or before January 15 of the calendar year in which the institution seeks to begin the new endorsement program.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

003.06A1 The application must include justification of interest and need for the proposed new endorsement program, educator competencies appropriate for the proposed new endorsement program, a list of the required courses that will address the competencies and accompanying syllabi, and the timetable for candidates' completion of the proposed new endorsement program.

003.06A2 The application must contain statements of support from school systems documenting the school systems' collaboration and assistance in planning to provide field experience placements which meet the requirements of this chapter and 92 NAC 24.

003.06A3 Within thirty (30) days from receipt of the application, the Commissioner must assign a team to assess the information provided in the application, which may include a visit to the institution. The team must include members representing the Nebraska Council on Teacher Education (NCTE) and persons with content knowledge in the proposed endorsement area.

003.06A4 The team must file a recommendation with the Commissioner for denial of the application or provisional approval.

003.06A5 The Commissioner must provide written notification by certified mail of the decision to the chief academic officer of the institution by May 1. The institution will have thirty (30) days after receipt of the notification to request a meeting with the Commissioner if the decision is to deny approval. Following the meeting, the Commissioner must inform the institution in writing if the decision to deny is upheld.

003.06B Provisional Approval of a Special Endorsement Authorization.

003.06B1 Following provisional approval by the Commissioner, the institution may phase in the new endorsement program, excluding clinical practice, over a period of time not to exceed three (3) years.

003.06B2 By March 1 of each year following provisional approval, the institution must file a written progress report on the program with the Commissioner which must include:

003.06B2a Enrollment data and documentation of written notification to the candidates stating that the institution has provisional approval and describing candidate recourse if the program is eliminated;

003.06B2b Statements of continuing participation from school systems for placement of candidates for field experiences; and

003.06B2c Reaffirmation or updated information regarding elements in Sections 003.06A1 and 003.06A2 of this chapter.

003.06B3 The review team identified in Section 003.06A3 of this chapter must review the progress report, which may include an onsite visit, and file a recommendation of

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

denial, continued provisional approval, or temporary approval with the Commissioner within thirty (30) days following the review.

003.06B4 The Commissioner must provide written notification by certified mail of the decision to the chief academic officer of the institution by May 1. The institution will have thirty (30) days after receipt of the notification to request a meeting with the Commissioner if the decision is to deny approval. Following the meeting, the Commissioner must inform the institution in writing if the subsequent decision to deny is upheld.

003.06C Temporary Approval of a Special Endorsement Authorization.

003.06C1 Following temporary approval by the Commissioner, the endorsement program may place candidates and recommend completers of the program for certification by the Department.

003.06C2 By March 1 of each year following temporary approval, the institution must file a written progress report on the program with the Commissioner. The progress report must include:

003.06C2a Enrollment data and documentation of written notification to the candidates stating that the institution has temporary approval and describing candidate recourse if the program is eliminated;

003.06C2b Statements of continuing participation from school systems for placement of candidates for field experiences; and

003.06C2c Reaffirmation or updated information regarding elements in Sections 003.06A1 and 003.06A2 of this chapter.

003.06C3 The review team identified in Section 003.06A3 of this chapter must review the progress report, which may include an onsite visit, and file a recommendation with the Commissioner to (a) continue temporary approval until the endorsement is placed in 92 NAC 24, (b) return to provisional status, or (c) deny any further approval.

003.06C4 By May 1, the Commissioner must consider the team's recommendation and provide written notification by certified mail to the chief academic officer of the institution of the decision to (a) renew temporary approval for a period not to exceed three (3) years, (b) return the endorsement to provisional status, (c) deny further approval and the reasons for the decision, or (d) recommend the special authorization be moved forward for inclusion in 92 NAC 24.

003.06C5 The institution will have thirty (30) days after receipt of the notification to request a meeting with the Commissioner if the decision is to deny approval. Following the meeting, the Commissioner must inform the institution in writing if the decision to deny is upheld.

004 Educator Preparation Program Requirements.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

004.01 General Policy Statements. The institution must have a written policy stating its objectives which delineates its goals and commitment to the preparation of educators. Not all of the programs for the preparation of school personnel need to be administratively located within the educator preparation program; however all professional education programs must be organized and coordinated by the educator preparation program.

004.02 Personnel Requirements.

004.02A Program Administrator. The institution must designate an individual to administer the professional educator preparation program. This individual is required to hold, qualify for, or have held an educator certificate.

004.02B Certification Officer. The institution must designate a faculty or staff member to receive correspondence regarding this chapter and to oversee the submission of certified records, transcripts, reports, and/or recommendations to the Department for the purpose of certification and/or endorsement.

004.02C Field Experience Coordinator. The institution must designate a faculty or staff member to coordinate field experience requirements contained in this chapter.

004.02D Cooperating Educators. The institution must ensure that cooperating educators employed by school systems or other field-based settings have a minimum of three (3) years of education employment experience and hold an appropriate certificate with an endorsement in the area or level they are supervising.

004.03 Educator Preparation Program Faculty Requirements.

004.03A Minimum Required Faculty

004.03A1 Undergraduate faculty. There must be a minimum of three (3) full-time professional education faculty.

004.03A2 Graduate faculty. Each advanced degree program leading to the doctorate must have at least three (3) full-time professional education faculty members who have earned the doctorate in the field of specialization for which the degree is offered.

004.03B Faculty Qualifications

004.03B1 All professional education faculty must hold a graduate degree or a professional degree from a college or university accredited by an accrediting organization recognized by the United States Department of Education.

004.03B2 The preparation, research, and experience of each faculty member must be in the field in which the faculty member teaches.

004.03B3 All professional education faculty, hired after July 1, 1994, must have two (2) years of PK-12 teaching experience in elementary or secondary schools approved or accredited by a state or in similarly constituted and governed schools in a state where non-public schools are not recognized by the state.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

Faculty who do not possess two (2) years of PK-12 teaching experience must meet the exceptional expertise requirement.

004.03B4 At least one-third of the full-time undergraduate faculty must hold a terminal degree.

004.03B5 At least one-half of full-time graduate faculty must hold a terminal degree.

004.03B6 All faculty in programs which grant the sixth year specialist's certificate or doctorate degree must hold the doctorate and have two (2) years of teaching or school administration experience.

004.03B7 Faculty who do not possess a terminal degree must meet the exceptional expertise requirement.

004.03B8 Adjunct faculty utilized for clinical experience supervision must hold or have held appropriate certification for the area or level which they are supervising.

004.03C Faculty Load

004.03C1 For undergraduate faculty, assignments for teaching, supervision of clinical experience, and administration must not exceed twenty-four (24) credit hours within the same academic year for a full-time equivalent undergraduate faculty member except as provided in Section 004.03C3 of this chapter.

004.03C2 For graduate faculty, assignments for teaching, supervision of clinical experience, and administration must not exceed eighteen (18) credit hours within the same academic year for a full-time equivalent graduate faculty member with the exception stated in Section 004.03C3 of this chapter.

004.03C3 For faculty teaching a combination of undergraduate and graduate assignments, the load may be a proration of nine (9) undergraduate and twelve (12) graduate credit hours, with total hours assigned within the same academic year not to exceed twenty-one (21) hours.

004.03C4 Supervision of clinical experiences must not exceed a ratio of eighteen (18) full-time equivalent candidates to one (1) full-time equivalent faculty member within one (1) semester.

004.04 Minimum Endorsement Offering Requirements. The institution must offer courses for a minimum of eight (8) approved subject and/or field endorsements contained in 92 NAC 24 and have on file a plan of study documenting that required courses are offered on a schedule to enable candidates access to the coursework in a four (4) year period.

004.05 Library Requirements. Library holdings, curriculum materials, and related technology resources must provide adequate scope, breadth, and currency to support education candidates and faculty. The institution must employ staff to work collaboratively with the

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

educator preparation program to acquire relevant and current resources and to provide support services for material utilization.

004.06 Policies for Program Admission, Progression, and Completion. The institution must have on file, and systematically communicate to all candidates, specific requirements regarding candidate admission, progression, and completion of the educator preparation program, including:

004.06A Disclosure. The institution must require the prospective candidate to disclose all criminal convictions, except traffic offenses.

004.06B Notice Regarding Convictions. The institution must inform all persons who apply for admission to its program that persons who have felony convictions or misdemeanor convictions involving abuse, neglect, or sexual misconduct, as outlined in 92 NAC 21, Section 003.12, may only be considered for certification, or participation in field experiences, with the approval of the Department. A person with a felony conviction or a misdemeanor conviction involving abuse, neglect, or sexual misconduct may request the approval of the Department using the procedures set forth in 92 NAC 21, Sections 009.02 through 009.04.

004.06C Criminal Background Check. The institution must conduct or verify an official criminal background check on candidates prior to admission to an initial teacher educator preparation program.

004.06D Grade Point Average.

004.06D1 Candidates must hold a cumulative GPA, as measured by the institution, of 2.5 on a 4.0 scale or its equivalent for admission to an educator preparation program.

004.06D2 Candidates for admission to clinical practice must hold a cumulative GPA, as measured by the institution, of at least 2.75 on a 4.0 scale or its equivalent.

004.06E Application. Candidates for admission to an educator preparation program must complete an application process which includes consideration of components identified in Section 004.06 of this chapter and other institution-determined criteria for selection, such as recommendations from professional educators, interviews, or essays.

004.06F Performance Assessments. The institution must identify the performance standards and assessments for successful progression and completion of the education programs offered by the educator preparation program.

005 Teacher Preparation Academic Program Requirements.

005.01 General Education Requirements. The institution must require all candidates meet the institution's general education requirements, which may also be used to meet endorsement requirements.

005.02 Professional Education Requirements.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

The educator preparation program must identify required coursework and/or competency leading to candidate demonstration of the following:

005.02A Student Development. The candidate understands how students grow and develop, recognizing that patterns of learning and development vary individually within and across the cognitive, linguistic, social, emotional, and physical areas, and designs and implements developmentally appropriate and challenging learning experiences;

005.02B Learning Differences. The candidate uses understanding of individual differences and diverse cultures and communities to ensure inclusive learning environments that enable each student to meet high standards;

005.02C Learning Environments. The candidate works with others to create environments supporting individual and collaborative learning, and encouraging positive social interaction, active engagement in learning, and self-motivation;

005.02D Content Knowledge. The candidate understands the central concepts, tools of inquiry, and structures of the discipline(s) he or she teaches and creates learning experiences that make these aspects of the discipline accessible and meaningful for students to assure mastery of the content, including the ability to integrate the Nebraska Content Standards (92 NAC 10 Appendices A-D) into instruction;

005.02E Application of Content. The candidate understands how to connect concepts and use differing perspectives to engage students in critical thinking, creativity, and collaborative problem solving related to authentic local and global issues;

005.02F Assessment. The candidate understands and uses multiple methods of assessment to engage students in their own growth, to monitor student progress, and to guide the candidate's and student's decision making;

005.02G Planning for Instruction. The candidate plans instruction supporting every student in meeting rigorous learning goals by drawing upon knowledge of content areas, curriculum, cross-disciplinary skills, technology, and pedagogy, as well as knowledge of the student and the community context;

005.02H Instructional Strategies. The candidate understands and uses a variety of instructional strategies to encourage students to develop deep understanding of content areas and their connections, build reading and writing skills through the application of the science of reading, and to apply knowledge in meaningful ways. This includes developing competency for utilizing technology for instruction, assessment, and communication;

005.02I Professional Learning and Ethical Practice. The candidate engages in ongoing professional learning, models ethical professional practice, and uses evidence to continually evaluate his/her practice, particularly the effects of his/her choices and actions on others (students, families, other professionals, and the community), and adapts practice to meet the needs of each student;

005.02J Leadership and Collaboration. The candidate seeks opportunities to take responsibility for student learning, to collaborate with students, families, colleagues, other

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

school professionals, and community members to ensure student growth, and to advance the profession;

005.02K Human Relations. The candidate has met the human relations requirement; and

005.02L Special Education. The candidate has met the special education requirement.

005.03 Field Experience. The educator preparation program must require practicum and clinical experiences that provide candidates opportunities to work with students and school partners to develop knowledge, skills, and professional dispositions. Field experiences are central to candidate preparation and must provide opportunities to work with diverse students which may include, but is not limited to, differences based on ethnicity, race, socioeconomic status, gender, exceptionalities, and language. These experiences range from candidate interaction with students to assuming responsibility for instructional planning and implementation, and assessment of student learning.

005.03A Practicum experience consists of a minimum of one hundred (100) clock hours of contact with students. Field-based practicum experiences are completed prior to clinical practice and provide opportunities for candidates to observe, assist, tutor, instruct, or conduct research. Practicum experiences may occur in settings such as school systems, or other settings serving students.

005.03B Clinical Practice. The educator preparation program must require a clinical practice experience for initial teacher certification in which candidates demonstrate knowledge, skills, and professional dispositions by assuming responsibility for whole class instruction in the area of the endorsement and within the grade level for which they are preparing.

005.03B1 The educator preparation program must have a clear statement of policies and procedures relating to clinical practice available, together with the Standards for Professional Practices Criteria in 92 NAC 27, to all persons involved in the clinical practice experience.

005.03B2 All clinical practice must be conducted in a Nebraska school system, or in an approved, accredited, or otherwise legally operated school in another state or country where teachers and administrators in the school are required by law or regulation to be certificated by the state or nation's educational authority.

005.03B3 The educator preparation program must engage with school partners on a regular and ongoing basis to develop and communicate the roles and responsibilities of candidates, college supervisors, cooperating educators, and other school personnel; to provide opportunities for school partners to provide input to the program regarding candidate placements, candidate performance, and program improvement; and to develop opportunities for faculty and school-based educators to work collaboratively to enhance candidate development.

005.03B3a The educator preparation program must negotiate written agreements delineating the roles and responsibilities of candidates in clinical practice, college supervisors, and the cooperating educators.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

005.03B4 The educator preparation program must require a clinical practice experience equivalent to:

005.03B4a A minimum of one (1) semester (at least fourteen (14) full-day weeks) for one (1) field endorsement; one (1) field endorsement and one (1) subject endorsement which is a content area specified in the field endorsement and is at the same grade level; or up to two (2) subject endorsements at the same grade level;

005.03B4b A minimum of eighteen (18) full-day weeks for two (2) field endorsements; one (1) field endorsement and one (1) subject endorsement which is not a content area specified in the field endorsement; one (1) field endorsement and one (1) subject endorsement which is a content area specified in the field endorsement but is not at the same grade level; or two (2) subject endorsements which are not at the same grade level; and

005.03B4c A minimum of an additional nine (9) full-day weeks for each field or subject endorsement added to those described in Section 005.03B4a or Section 005.03B4b of this chapter.

005.03B5 The educator preparation program must ensure that a minimum of five (5) formal observations by faculty are conducted during clinical practice for candidates preparing for initial level teaching certification. Two (2) observations must be onsite and three (3) of the observations may be conducted utilizing technology which allows for visual contact between the parties.

005.03C Speech Language Pathology and School Psychologist Preparation Programs at the Initial Teacher Certification Level Field Experience. The educator preparation program must ensure that a minimum of three (3) formal onsite observations by faculty are conducted.

006 Administrator Program Academic Requirements.

006.01 Education Preparation Administrative Academic Program Requirements. The educator preparation program must identify required coursework and/or competency leading to candidate demonstration of the following:

006.01A Mission, Vision and Core Values. The candidate develops, advocates, and enacts the shared mission, vision, and core values of high-quality education, academic success, and the well-being of each student.

006.01B Ethics and Professional Norms. The candidate acts ethically and according to professional norms to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

006.01C Equity and Cultural Responsiveness. The candidate strives for equity of educational opportunity and culturally responsive practices to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

006.01D Curriculum, Instruction, and Assessment. The candidate develops and supports intellectually rigorous and coherent systems of curriculum, instruction, and assessment to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

006.01E Community of Care and Support for Students. The candidate develops and supports intellectually rigorous and coherent systems of curriculum, instruction, and assessment to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

006.01F Professional Capacity of School Personnel. The candidate develops the professional capacity and practice of school personnel to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

006.01G Professional Community for Teachers and Staff. The candidate fosters a professional community of teachers and other professional staff to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

006.01H Meaningful Engagement of Family and Community. The candidate engages families and the community in meaningful, reciprocal, and mutually beneficial ways to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

006.01I Operations and Management. The candidate manages school operations and resources to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

006.01J School Improvement. The candidate acts as an agent of continuous improvement to promote each student's academic success and well-being.

006.02 Advanced Program Field Experience.

006.02A The educator preparation program must have a clear statement of policies and procedures relating to field experiences which shall be made available, together with the Standards for Professional Practices Criteria in 92 NAC 27, to all persons involved in the field experience.

006.02B The educator preparation program must require field experiences for advanced certification programs.

006.02C All clinical practice must be conducted in a Nebraska school system, or in an approved, accredited or otherwise legally operated school in another state or an English-speaking school in another country where teachers and administrators in the school are required by law or regulation to be certificated by the state or nation's educational authority.

006.02D The educator preparation program must engage with school partners on a regular and ongoing basis to develop and communicate the roles and responsibilities of candidates, college supervisors, cooperating educators, and other school personnel; to provide opportunities for school partners to provide input to the program regarding candidate placements, candidate performance, and program improvement; and to develop the skills of faculty and school-based educators to work collaboratively to enhance candidate development.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

007 Program Quality Indicators. The educator preparation program must establish a systematic process to address and document the following program quality indicators:

007.01 Candidate Admission and Completion. The educator preparation program utilizes information related to candidate admission, progression, completion, and graduate employment to document the institution's continuing and purposeful expectations for candidate quality;

007.02 Content Knowledge. The educator preparation program utilizes candidate performance information from content tests, as set forth in 92 NAC 24, to determine potential areas for improvement in content knowledge preparation of candidates;

007.03 Program Completer Follow-up. The educator preparation program utilizes a graduate follow-up process to obtain program completer input regarding satisfaction, relevance and effectiveness of their preparation for professional roles and responsibilities.

007.04 Employer Follow-up. The educator preparation program utilizes a process for collecting information from employers regarding satisfaction with the program and program completers;

007.05 Program Completer Support. The educator preparation program makes resources available to support its completers who are within the education profession; and

007.06 Continuous Program Improvement. The educator preparation program initiates continuous program improvement strategies based on regular analysis of data, current research, and/or as the result of engagement with PK-12 education partners regarding initiatives and challenges of PK-12 education.

008 Provisions for Notice and Hearing.

008.01 When the Commissioner makes a recommendation to the Board for an institution to be placed on probation or for the denial of continuing approval, notice of the recommendation and of the right to request a hearing within thirty (30) days after receipt must be given to the institution by certified mail. Copies must be sent to the certification officer and the chief executive officer, if known. This notice must specify the basis for the recommendation and the tentative date the Board will consider the recommendation unless a formal hearing is requested.

008.02 If the institution files a request for a formal hearing within thirty (30) days after receipt of the recommendation, the Board must schedule a hearing date. If no formal hearing is requested, the recommendation must be considered by the Board and adopted or modified by order of the Board.

008.03 All hearings arising under this chapter must be conducted in accordance with the hearing procedures of Chapter 61 of Title 92 of the Nebraska Administrative Code.

TITLE 92 - NEBRASKA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
CHAPTER 20 - APPROVAL OF EDUCATOR PREPARATION PROGRAMS

009 Pilot Programs and Processes. An educator preparation program may submit a request to the Board for a pilot program or process to provide flexibility related to one or more regulations found in Sections 004.01 to 004.05, 004.06D to 004.06F, 005, and 006 of this chapter.

009.01 The rationale for a request for a pilot program or process may be to:

009.01A Better meet local goals;

009.01B Create an innovative solution to an unmet need; or

009.01C Respond to extenuating circumstances that cause the educator preparation program to be unable to meet one or more requirement of any section of this chapter.

009.02 The request for a pilot program or process must include at least the following:

009.02A An explanation of the circumstances leading to the request;

009.02B A description of how the pilot program or process will substitute for one or more existing regulations;

009.02C An explanation of how the program or process will provide equivalent or improved opportunities for candidates;

009.02D If appropriate, how resources will be reallocated or used differently to provide programs or services;

009.02E The length of time, not to exceed three (3) years, requested for the pilot program or process; and

009.02F Procedures for providing an annual progress report to the Board.

009.03 The Board may approve the requested pilot program or process for up three (3) years if the plan demonstrates a high likelihood that the requested flexibility related to applicable regulations of this Chapter will promote quality learning, equity, and/or accountability. The Board must reject the pilot program or process if the plan does not demonstrate a high likelihood that the requested flexibility will not promote quality learning, equity, and/or accountability.

009.04 At the end of the approved time period for the pilot program or process, the educator preparation program may request, and be granted, Board approval to continue the pilot program for a period of up to three (3) additional years if the educator preparation program demonstrates that the pilot program or process is meeting the objectives for which flexibility related to applicable regulations of this Chapter was granted.